प्रधान आयुक्त सीमा शुल्क (आयात) का कार्यालय
OFFICE OF THE PR. COMMISSIONER OF CUSTOMS (IMPORT),
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Date:

MINUTES OF THE PERMANENT TRADE FACILITATION COMMITTEE MEETING HELD ON 19.01.2026

The meeting of Permanent Trade Facilitation Committee (PTFC), for the month of January 2026 was held in the Conference Hall of ACC at 12:00 Noon on 19.01.2026 and was chaired by Shri Manish Chandra, Principal Commissioner of Customs (Import) and co-chaired by Shri Hardeep Batra, Commissioner of Customs (Export). The following officers and representatives participated in the meeting:

Sl. no.	Name & Designation	Organization
1	Shri Tagadi Manjunath, Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
2	Shri Neelesh Rautkar, Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
3	Shri Vijay Manvatkar, Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
4	Shri N Pandiyaraj, Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
5	Ms. Daribha Lyndem, Joint Commissioner (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
6	Shri Kanhaiya Poddar, Deputy Commissioner of Customs (Import Shed)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
7	Shri Kiran V. Vaidya, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
8	Shri M. Sree Harsha, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import Shed)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
9	Shri Jai Singh Rathore, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
10	Shri S. J. George, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
11	Shri Gautam Shelare, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
12	Shri Itha Ramalingeshwara Rao, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Group - V (A))	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
13	Shri Deepak Kumar Singh, Superintendent, (Import Technical)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
14	Shri Shashank Shekhar, Examiner, (Import Technical)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai

15	Shri Sourav Kumar, Examiner, (Import Technical)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai

Sl. no.	Name of Attendees of Stakeholders	Organization
1	Shri Sanjeev Harale, President	BCBA
2	Shri Kaushal Thakkar, Import Chairman	BCBA
3	Shri Paresh Sangani, Chairman	BCBA
4	Shri Dushyant Mulani, Chairman	FFFAI
5	Shri Ketan Desai, Secretary	BCBA
6	Shri Mark S Fernandes, Director	IMCCI
7	Dr. Ranjith. M, APPO (E)	PQ
8	Dr. Sharmila Amin, Co-convenor (WRC)	AMTOI
9	Shri Shailesh Sharma, Secretary	ACAAI
10	Shri Jankiram Kadam, Tech officer	FSSAI
11	Shri Swapnil S. Harekar, Dy, Manager	MIAL Security
12	Shri Vishal V. Kamble, Dy. Manager	MIAL Security
13	Shri Gaurav Sabnis, Associate Manager	MIAL
14	Shri Mukesh Marolia, Associate Manager	MCSCAPL
15	Shri Subodh Thakur, Manager	MCSCAPL
16	Shri Mandar Rane, CSO	MCSCAPL
17	Shri Amit Kadam, Asst. Manager	MIAL
18	Shri Somel Thakkar, Managing Director	Zeus Air Services
19	Shri Nischal D'Souza, Deputy Manager	MCSCAPL
20	Shri Vikas A Shinde, T.O.	CDSCO
21	Shri Hiren Joshi, Deputy Task Manager	AIASL
22	Shri Karan Rambhia, Member	FFFAI

The Principal Commissioner of Customs welcomed all the attendees. There were 07 points open for discussion from the last PTFC meeting dated 18.12.2025. Accordingly, those agenda points were taken up for discussion and decision: -

OPEN POINTS FROM LAST PTFC MEETING HELD ON 18.12.2025

1) Review of 3rd Country Export Formalities:

The BCBA has highlighted that the existing procedure for processing for 3rd country needs to be reviewed as the process is cumbersome and time-consuming.

Discussion and Decision:

ADC (I), informed that a meeting was conducted with MIAL and BCBA for assessing the feasibility of setting up of a Bonded Warehouse in the ACC premises. MIAL was to submit the action plans. Additionally, a meeting with Commissionerates was conducted for streamlining the procedures for third country Re-export.

ADC (I), further informed that MIAL has not yet submitted the proposal for setting up of a Bonded Warehouse. The final report regarding streamlining of

procedure of third country Re-export will be submitted after proposal from MIAL is received.

MIAL representative Shri Gaurav Sabnis informed that the tariff proposal and space for Bonded Warehouse was under review at their end.

Principal Commissioner instructed MIAL to initiate the process for setting up Bonded Warehouse facilities at the earliest being a Trade requirement repeatedly being brought up in PTFC.

(Point Closed)
Action: MIAL

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2) Delay in Faceless Assessment Due to Non-Intimation of B/E Status:

BCBA highlighted that Customs Brokers are facing significant delays when Bills of Entry are pushed back to the PAG without any system-generated intimation. In such cases, the Customs Broker is unable to ascertain the status of the Bill of Entry for four to five days.

BCBA further pointed out that there is presently no designated contact point or helpdesk to trace such "missing" Bills of Entry and that delays continue even after complaints are registered through AEM.

BCBA requested that necessary departmental assistance be provided to promptly trace and communicate the status of such Bills of Entry upon request from Customs Brokers.

Discussion and Decision:

ADC (I), informed that this is a Policy decision and even the officers are not able to determine the location of a BE.

Principal Commissioner said that such cases are taken up by PAG and if their processing is delayed, TSK complaints should be made. The Pushbacks result in reassessments / issue of Section 17(5) orders through due process. (A proposal for SOP in dealing with Pushbacks has already been sent to Convenors – NAC 5 and 5 A/C/M).

(Point Closed)
Action: BCBA

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3) Delay in Bonding of the goods:

BCBA highlighted that Into-Bond Bills of Entry are being kept on hold until receipt of the NOC from Plant Quarantine (PGA), resulting in levy of substantial demurrage charges at the Air Cargo Complex (ACC).

BCBA pointed out that earlier, bonding of such Bills of Entry was permitted prior to receipt of the PGA NOC. Reference was made to JNCH Public Notice No. 23/2017 dated 01.03.2017, wherein similar facilitation had been extended. On behalf of the trade, BCBA requested issuance of a similar Public Notice at ACC permitting bonding of goods pending receipt of the PGA NOC, so as to avoid undue delays and mitigate high demurrage charges.

Discussion and Decision:

Principal Commissioner stated that Board's instructions dated 26.02.2016 are being followed at the time of Into Bond stage for a Warehouse BE.

BCBA representative Shri Paresh Sangani requested that as the current procedure is causing them high demurrage charges, ex-bonding may be allowed only subject to Test report.

Principal Commissioner stated that decision may be taken on case to case basis in case the import volumes are high. It was also stated that the matter will be escalated to Board, for which BCBA may submit representation.

(Point Closed)
Action: BCBA

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4) Labour shortage at MIAL Export Heavy Shed:

BCBA highlighted a recurring and acute shortage of labour at the MIAL Export Heavy Shed, particularly during peak hours and in the days preceding holidays. It was further pointed out that similar shortages were experienced even during the previous week.

BCBA stated that due to inadequate manpower, there are significant delays in cargo handling and clearance, causing operational difficulties for the trade. BCBA requested that adequate manpower be deployed at the Heavy Shed, especially during peak periods and holidays, to ensure smooth and timely cargo operations.

Discussion and Decision:

Commissioner (Export) suggested BCBA to check their records for labour shortage during the period as it was suggested to maintain the record in the last PTFC meeting and also advised to bring it to his notice whenever such situation arises.

(Point Closed)
Action: BCBA

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5) Scanning machines not working at MIAL Export Heavy shed:

BCBA highlighted that all scanning machines at the MIAL Export Heavy Shed are not operational simultaneously, as one or two machines are often under repair or servicing. Consequently, cargo load is diverted to the remaining machines, leading to congestion, particularly during peak hours and pre-holiday periods. BCBA pointed out that the slow pace of scanning under such circumstances results in delays in cargo clearance.

BCBA requested that all scanning machines be made fully operational from morning hours, especially during peak periods, to ensure smooth and timely clearance of export cargo.

Discussion and Decision:

MIAL representative Shri Mandar Rane informed that all the scanning machines are presently operational.

Commissioner (Export) affirmed that during his visit to Export Heavy Shed, all the machines were found to be in working condition.

(Point Closed)

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6) Space issue in Perishable Cargo Terminal (PCT):

BCBA highlighted that severe congestion is being experienced at the Perishable Cargo Terminal due to acute space constraints. As a result, vehicles are taking considerable time for off-loading, leading to increased detention and adversely impacting cargo handling operations, including flight delays.

BCBA requested that the matter be taken up with the Cargo Service Centre (CSC) for augmentation of space and handling capacity, so that increased volumes can be managed efficiently and goods can be off-loaded in a timely manner.

Discussion and Decision:

MCSCAPL representative Shri Subodh Thakur informed that PCT in-charge was not available to attend this meeting and committed on briefing him on the issue.

(Point Open)
Action: MIAL

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7) Installation of a Gate Scanner for Oversized Cargo:

ACAAI highlighted the long-pending requirement for installation of a dedicated Gate Scanner at ACC Sahar for oversized cargo, similar to JNPT, to avoid manual examination that causes congestion, delays, and inefficiencies. The facility would improve scanning efficiency, compliance, and support EXIM trade. ACAAI requested that the matter be taken up on priority with a clear implementation roadmap and timeline.

Discussion and Decision:

MIAL representative Shri Mandar Rane informed that they have installed a Scanning Machine (180*180 mm) for oversized cargo. The facility for installing a bigger Scanning Machine has to be developed as it requires infrastructure upgradation.

Principal Commissioner advised MIAL to make the Gate Scanner facility available at Air Cargo Complex being a Trade and operational requirement. This should be done in consultation with Customs.

(Point Closed)
Action: MIAL

NEW AGENDA POINTS RECEIVED FROM TRADE/STAKEHOLDERS

1) **RMS Bills of Entry being opened for physical examination in sheds**

BCBA highlighted that RMS Bills of Entry are being physically opened in the Shed, resulting in avoidable delays in clearance. BCBA requested that, in cases where RMS with CCR prescribes verification of CTH / Notification only, examination be carried out without opening the packages, and that shed officers be suitably sensitised to prevent unnecessary opening of packages and consequent delays.

Discussion and Decision:

DC, Shed (Import) clarified that some Bills of Entry are facilitated by RMS for assessment only and are required to be examined before grant of OOC. RMS facilitation, when applied to Examination, (No Examination is prescribed) is followed, i.e. there is no examination by Shed in such cases. The case referred by BCBA is an RMS facilitated BE for Assessment only for which Examination is clearly prescribed.

(Point Closed)

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2) **Delay in refund under Section 74 of the Customs Act, 1962**

BCBA highlighted that members of the trade have reported inordinate delays in processing refunds under Section 74, with several refund applications submitted long ago still pending. BCBA requested that such pending cases be reviewed and expedited.

Discussion and Decision:

Commissioner (Export) informed that a drive was undertaken recently to clear the pending refund claims. It was further informed that some of the very old cases are facing delays owing to pending Test reports, EGM Error and non-reply to queries.

Commissioner informed that the refund cases are being monitored regularly. BCBA was advised to bring to notice any delay in regular refund cases and share a list of all such cases, if any.

(Point Closed)

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3) **Lack of acknowledgement and response from TSK Department**

BCBA highlighted that Customs Brokers / Importers are sending emails to the TSK Department for expediting Bills of Entry pending with FAG officers, but no acknowledgement of receipt or status update is being provided. BCBA requested that the TSK Department acknowledge emails received and respond with the current status of the concerned Bills of Entry to reduce uncertainty and clearance delays.

Discussion and Decision:

AC, TSK informed that grievances received from importers on TSK email are acknowledged immediately through system-generated automated emails and these grievances are regularly monitored and promptly forwarded on the same day to the concerned NAC for necessary action. The status of these Bills of Entry, including the date of Out of Charge (OOC) is also monitored and maintained at TSK, and reminders are issued wherever required.

Principal Commissioner stated that each TSK and AEM grievance is being monitored from filing to resolution.

(Point Closed)

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4) **Demand of Manual endorsement of FSSAI NOC causing delay in OOC**

BCBA highlighted that in cases where Bills of Entry are subject to FSSAI NOC, Shed officers are insisting on a printed copy of the FSSAI NOC with manual endorsement from the FSSAI officer, followed by re-uploading on e-Sanchit, causing significant delays due to the manual process. BCBA requested that, since FSSAI grants clearance online, the manual procedure be dispensed with and digital approval be accepted for granting OOC.

Discussion and Decision:

FSSAI officer Shri Jankiram Kadam informed that NOCs for consignments are being given in online mode only.

DC, Shed (Import) has clarified that CBs approach Shed staff for manual entry of NOC details only when the NOC has not been transmitted to ICES. In such cases, a hard copy of the NOC is required for System entry and it is to be uploaded on e-Sanchit for record preservation. Manual endorsement by FSSAI official is mandatory to authenticate the document.

Principal Commissioner stated that due to transmission lag in System, manual copy of NOC is required for the details of the NOC. It was informed to the Trade that cases of PGA NOC forgery are under investigation in this Commissionerate. Therefore, submission of duly signed manual copies in the absence of soft copies are mandatory for clearing the consignments in some cases which have not transmitted in System because of time lag.

ADC (I) informed that SWIFT 2.0 onboarding is currently underway. Once fully operational, it will resolve all transmission lag issues.

(Point Closed)

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5) **Delay in processing of AEO applications at ACC Mumbai**

BCBA highlighted that there are considerable delays in processing AEO applications at ACC Mumbai. BCBA requested that pending applications be taken up on priority and processed expeditiously.

Discussion and Decision:

Commissioner (Export) stated that AEO cases are being monitored regularly. It was advised that whenever any case of delay is faced, it should be brought into notice immediately.

(Point Closed)

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6) **Traffic management by MIAL for EXIM cargo vehicles**

BCBA requested that MIAL strengthen supervision and management of traffic movement for EXIM cargo vehicles, particularly at entry and exit points, to avoid congestion and operational delays.

Discussion and Decision:

MIAL representative Shri Swapnil S. Harekar informed that steps have been taken to ensure better traffic management like 24 hours shift duty of traffic managers.

Principal Commissioner expressed dissatisfaction with the current traffic situation and stated that there is a requirement for better management of traffic and supervision. The traffic conditions are adversely affecting officers/staff and visitors as there is no dedicated or even delineated pathway.

(Point Closed)
(Action: MIAL)

Principal Commissioner informed that there are still many BEs filed during 1-7 January which are covered in the 2026 Time Release Study (TRS) but not cleared even after 2 weeks on account of duty not paid, goods not presented for examination, queries not replied, PGA NOCs pending. This is adversely impacting the TRS Dwell Time and BCBA, PGAs have to take steps for their complete processing. A list of such cases is being sent to BCBA daily for necessary action. The TRS results will show the effectiveness or otherwise of various stakeholders. In the TRS of 2025, Mumbai ACC did not do well which should not be repeated in this year's TRS.

The meeting ending after the foregoing discussions.

This issues with the approval of the Principal Commissioner of Customs, Import, ACC, Mumbai.

T. 23/01/2026

(Tagadi Manjunath)
Additional Commissioner of Customs,
Import, ACC, Mumbai - III

Copy :-
1. Pr. Commissioner/ Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General, ACC.
2. All Addl./JC Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General/Pr.CCO, ACC.
3. All member of PTFC meeting including BCBA & ACAAI (via e-mail).
4. DC/EDI for uploading on ACC website (via e-mail).
5. PGAs, ACC Mumbai (via e-mail).
6. Office copy.